FITNESS / KNOWLEDGE SERIES

THE GYM SUPPLEMENT GUIDE

A practical Hinglish guide to what popular gym supplements do inside your body, when they may help, and when to be careful.

FOOD FIRST. TRAIN SMART. RECOVER WELL.

Supplements fill gaps. They do not replace regular meals, progressive training, rest, or adequate sleep.

PROTEIN / PERFORMANCE / BONES / HEALTH

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

8 common supplements | How they work | What is optional | Safety checklist

01 / BUILD & PERFORM

Muscle + performance

These are popular in strength training, but usefulness depends on diet, training and individual needs.

01 WHEY / PLANT PROTEIN

Protein is digested into amino acids, which the body uses to repair and build muscle proteins.

WHY IT MATTERS: Convenient when meals do not provide enough protein.

NOTE: Whey is dairy-based; soy/pea options can suit vegetarian diets.

02 CREATINE MONOHYDRATE

Raises muscle phosphocreatine stores, helping regenerate ATP during brief, intense efforts.

WHY IT MATTERS: May improve strength and repeated high-intensity exercise performance.

NOTE: Not essential; discuss use with a qualified clinician if under 18 or if you have kidney concerns.

03 MASS GAINER / CARB POWDER

Adds calories and carbohydrates; carbohydrates help replenish muscle glycogen.

WHY IT MATTERS: Only potentially useful when regular food cannot meet energy needs.

NOTE: Many products contain lots of sugar; food-based meals are usually preferable.

02 / SUPPORT SYSTEMS

Bones + daily health

Vitamins and minerals help normal body function. More is not automatically better.

04 VITAMIN D

Supports calcium absorption and normal muscle and bone function.

WHY IT MATTERS: Correcting deficiency supports bone health.

NOTE: Blood testing or clinical advice can guide supplementation; excess may be harmful.

05 CALCIUM

Needed for bones, nerve signaling and muscle contraction.

WHY IT MATTERS: Helps meet needs when food intake is inadequate.

NOTE: High-dose supplements can cause problems; avoid combining products without checking.

06 VITAMIN B12

Needed for red blood cells, DNA synthesis and healthy nerve function.

WHY IT MATTERS: Important to monitor in vegetarian or vegan diets.

NOTE: Supplementing helps when intake or levels are inadequate; it is not an instant energy booster.

07 OMEGA-3 (ALGAE OPTION)

Omega-3 fatty acids contribute to cell membrane structure and normal physiology.

WHY IT MATTERS: Can support overall nutrition; recovery benefits are uncertain.

NOTE: Algae-derived products are a vegetarian option; check product quality.

03 / SMART CHOICES

What is worth taking?

A quick checklist for choosing supplements without unnecessary spending or risk.

08 PRE-WORKOUT / CAFFEINE

Stimulants can temporarily increase alertness and reduce perceived effort.

WHY IT MATTERS: Not required for muscle growth or a productive workout.

NOTE: Can disrupt sleep and cause palpitations or anxiety; stimulant pre-workouts are not advised for teens.

YOUR PRIORITY ORDER

01	Balanced meals + sufficient energy
02	Consistent training + rest days
03	Sleep + hydration
04	Address verified nutrient gaps
05	Consider optional supplements only if appropriate

SAFETY FIRST

Avoid unverified muscle boosters, hormones and steroid-like products. Read labels, check for third-party testing, and consult a qualified health professional before taking supplements for a medical concern.

Educational information only - not a prescription or a personalized dosage plan.